THE PRICE OF DAWN — THE THREE CORE FACTIONS BESTIARY

Official 5e Stat Blocks · HP Damage Trackers · Calibrated for 5 Gestalt Lvl 7 PCs (10 Lvl 7 Eqv. / 17k+ XP) · 3 Core Powers

MASTER COMBAT QUICK-REFERENCE & INITIATIVE TRACKER (ALL 3 FACTIONS)

CREATURE / ROLE	CR	AC	HP (FORMULA)	SPEED	SENSES	KEY SAVES	COMBAT ROLE & THREAT
Commander Harran Lecht THE DELUDED LIGHT FANATICS	CR 9	18	142 (15d8 + 75)	30 ft.	Passive Perception 15	Str +9, Con +9, Wis +5, Cha +8	Charges directly for the center dais. Knocks party defenders prone and cleaves into backline ca...
Lieutenant Senna Kard THE DELUDED LIGHT FANATICS	CR 7	17	98 (14d8 + 35)	35 ft.	Passive Perception 16	Dex +7, Wis +6, Cha +6	Holds the secondary line 20 ft behind Harran, directing defensive maneuvers. If appealed to emo...
Reckoning Light-Inquisitor THE DELUDED LIGHT FANATICS	CR 6	17	88 (13d8 + 30)	30 ft.	Passive Perception 16	Wis +6, Cha +6, Con +6	Targets party spellcasters and healers. Uses Purifying Flare early to blind frontliners, then h...
Fanatic Sun-Priest THE DELUDED LIGHT FANATICS	CR 5	15	68 (11d8 + 19)	30 ft.	Passive Perception 17	Wis +7, Con +5	Casts Spirit Guardians on turn 1, stays behind the shield wall, uses Guiding Bolt to paint targ...
Reckoning Veteran THE DELUDED LIGHT FANATICS	CR 4	18	72 (10d8 + 27)	30 ft.	Passive Perception 13	Str +5, Con +5	Forms a tight wedge with other Veterans, pushing PCs off the ritual stones and locking down cas...
Reckoning Crossbow Marksman THE DELUDED LIGHT FANATICS	CR 3	15	52 (8d8 + 16)	30 ft.	Passive Perception 14	Dex +5	Positioned on colonnades and archways. Focus fires on party spellcasters maintaining concentrat...
Deluded Zealot Militiaman THE DELUDED LIGHT FANATICS	CR 1	13	33 (6d8 + 6)	30 ft.	Passive Perception 10	None	Swarms in numbers. Uses reckless attacks to pin PCs in place so Veterans and Harran can advance...
Arch-Lich Vhol THE UNDEAD FACTION	CR 16	18	195 (23d8 + 92)	30 ft., fly 40 ft. (hover)	Truesight 60 ft., Darkvision 120 ft., Passive Perception 20	Con +10, Int +12, Wis +10, Cha +10	Hovers 15 ft above the battlefield out of melee reach. Counters radiant spells immediately. Use...
Null-Warden THE UNDEAD FACTION	CR 13	19	185 (20d8 + 95)	30 ft.	Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 19	Str +10, Con +10, Wis +9, Int +8	Shadow steps directly into party backline to envelop casters in Greater Null Aura. Swings Null ...
Unlit Dread Shadow-Keeper THE UNDEAD FACTION	CR 10	18	135 (18d8 + 54)	30 ft.	Darkvision 120 ft., Passive Perception 17	Str +8, Con +8, Wis +7	Opens with Enveloping Umbra to blind backline party members. Teleports with Shadow Step and coo...
High Priest of the Inward Crescent THE UNDEAD FACTION	CR 9	16	120 (16d8 + 48)	30 ft.	Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 18	Int +7, Wis +8, Con +7	Maintains 4th-level Spirit Guardians, counterspells radiant magic, grants 20 temp HP shields to...
Unlit Doctrinal Voice THE UNDEAD FACTION	CR 9	15	105 (15d8 + 38)	30 ft.	Passive Perception 14	Int +9, Wis +8, Cha +7	Casts Greater Invisibility on turn 1. Stays at maximum range launching Mind-Shatter Lance and O...
Dusk High Priest THE UNDEAD FACTION	CR 8	16	110 (15d8 + 45)	30 ft.	Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 18	Wis +8, Cha +7, Con +7	Commands The Returned to pin down targets. Uses Combat Animation to turn dead party allies/NPCs...
Unlit Shadow-Operative THE UNDEAD FACTION	CR 6	16	82 (12d8 + 28)	35 ft.	Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 15	Dex +7, Wis +5	Shadow-steps behind paralyzed or engaged PCs. Delivers 4d6 sneak attacks. Fades when targeted....
The Returned (Dread Ghast) THE UNDEAD FACTION	CR 5	15	85 (12d8 + 31)	35 ft.	Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 14	Con +6	Swarms heavily armored tanks. Inflicts paralysis with claws, then bites to heal. Operatives foc...
Concordance Obsidian Legionnaire THE UNDEAD FACTION	CR 3	18	52 (8d8 + 16)	30 ft.	Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 10	Str +5, Con +4	Locks down chokepoints and doorways with 10 ft reach halberds. Trips frontline tanks so Ghasts ...
The Gardener (Master Flesh-Shaper) THE FLOWERING	CR 12	17	175 (19d8 + 95)	35 ft., climb 35 ft.	Blindsight 30 ft., Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 17	Con +9, Int +9, Wis +7, Dex +9	Stays behind Tendril Behemoth and Abomination, transferring 50% damage to them while regenerati...
Grasping Tendril Behemoth THE FLOWERING	CR 9	15	145 (16d10 + 57)	40 ft., climb 30 ft.	Blindsight 40 ft., Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 11	Str +10, Con +9	Ignores heavy armor tanks unless blocked. Reaches over defenders with 15 ft reach to snatch Ixa...
Flower-Bred Flesh Goliath THE FLOWERING	CR 8	16	130 (14d10 + 53)	35 ft.	Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 10	Str +8, Con +7	Frontline battering ram. Smashes barricades, grapples party warriors, and holds them down for S...
Apex Bloom-Stalker THE FLOWERING	CR 6	16	88 (13d8 + 30)	40 ft., climb 35 ft.	Darkvision 60 ft., Tremorsense 30 ft., Passive Perception 15	Dex +8, Con +6	Stalks along rafters and ceilings. Pounces directly onto backline spellcasters, inflicts paraly...
Noxious Spore-Artillery THE FLOWERING	CR 5	14	75 (11d8 + 26)	25 ft.	Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 14	Con +6	Stands on vantage points lobbing acid mortars. When party warriors close in, detonate self to w...
Failed Flesh Graft-Amalgam THE FLOWERING	CR 3	13	55 (10d8 + 10)	25 ft., climb 25 ft.	Blindsight 30 ft., Passive Perception 9	None	Crawls out of grates and gutters, wraps around boots, and lets out a deafening pain shriek to s...

FACTION 1: DELUDED LIGHT FANATICS

Identity: Mostly human zealots (The Reckoning). Their facts are backwards—they genuinely believe forcing the dawn or sacrificing Dawnborn is heroic martyrdom.

Table Dynamic: Driven by tragic conviction, not evil. They fight with military discipline and righteous desperation, but can be morally broken or reasoned with (Senna Kard).

FACTION 2: THE UNDEAD (CONCORDANCE)

Identity: Deathless covenant ruled by **Arch-Lich Vhol**. They embrace the eternal twilight as their ascension and use null-magic to sever the sun forever.

Table Dynamic: Cold, methodical, lethal. They employ anti-magic Null Auras, paralyzing claws, necrosis, and shadow-stepping inquisitors to silence resistance.

FACTION 3: THE FLOWERING (MUTANTS)

Identity: Underground bio-magical flesh-crafters led by **The Gardener**. They view physical laws as flaws to be overcome through mutation and horrific grafting.

Table Dynamic: Body-horror aberrations. Grasping rubbery tendrils, spore-spitters, multi-armed brutes, and relentless regenerating flesh seeking to reclaim Ixa.

FACTION 1: THE DELUDED LIGHT FANATICS — HIGH COMMAND

COMMANDER HARRAN LECHT

LORD COMMANDER OF THE RECKONING · MARTYR SOVEREIGN

Medium humanoid (human), lawful neutral

Armor Class: 18 (scarred plate)

Hit Points: 142 (15d8 + 75)

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HP Tracking: □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -2
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Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
20 (+5)	12 (+1)	20 (+5)	12 (+1)	12 (+1)	18 (+4)

Saving Throws: Str +9, Con +9, Wis +5, Cha +8
Skills: Athletics +9, Intimidation +8, Perception +5
Condition Immunities: Charmed, frightened
Senses: Passive Perception 15
Languages: Common
Challenge: 9 (5,000 XP)

Desperate Martyrdom. While below 70 HP (bloodied), Harran gains a +3 bonus to attack rolls, moves +10 ft faster, and deals an extra 9 (2d8) radiant damage on melee hits. He fights with terrifying righteous fury.

Iron Command Aura. Allied soldiers within 30 ft add +1d6 to their attack rolls and saving throws, and cannot be frightened while Harran is conscious.

Legendary Fortitude (2/Day). If Harran fails a saving throw, he can choose to succeed instead.

The Unforgiving Choice. Harran cannot be persuaded to abandon his attack while conscious; only reducing him to 0 HP or completing the stone circle before his eyes will shatter his delusion.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. Harran makes three attacks: two with his Sun-Forged Broadsword and one with his Shield Slam.

Sun-Forged Broadsword. Melee Weapon Attack: +9 to hit (+12 if bloodied), reach 5 ft., one target. Hit: 14 (2d8 + 5) slashing plus 4 (1d8) radiant damage (or 23 (4d8+5) when bloodied).

Solar Shield Slam. Melee Weapon Attack: +9 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. Hit: 10 (1d10 + 5) bludgeoning. Target must succeed on a DC 17 Str save or be knocked prone and pushed 10 ft.

BONUS ACTIONS

Martyr's Rally (Recharge 5–6). Harran roars: 'For the stolen sun!' Up to four allied soldiers within 30 ft gain 20 temporary hit points and can immediately use their reaction to make a melee weapon attack.

REACTIONS

Unyielding Retaliation. When hit by a melee attack, Harran adds +4 to his AC against that attack. If the attack still hits, he makes an immediate melee counterattack against the attacker.

GM Tactics & Morale: Charges directly for the center dais. Knocks party defenders prone and cleaves into backline casters to disrupt the dawn ritual. At bloodied (under 70 HP), he ignores opportunity attacks to reach the primer stone. When reduced to 0 HP, seeing the circle flare with pure sunlight shatters his fanatical delusion in tears.

LIEUTENANT SENNA KARD

FIELD COMMANDER · MASTER DUELIST (CONFLICTED)

Medium humanoid (human), neutral good (conflicted)

Armor Class: 17 (studded leather + duelist buckler)

Hit Points: 98 (14d8 + 35)

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HP Tracking: □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -8
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Speed: 35 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
14 (+2)	18 (+4)	16 (+3)	14 (+2)	16 (+3)	16 (+3)

Saving Throws: Dex +7, Wis +6, Cha +6
Skills: Insight +6, Perception +6, Persuasion +6, Acrobatics +7
Senses: Passive Perception 16
Languages: Common
Challenge: 7 (2,900 XP)

Hesitant Conscience. Senna does not wish to butcher innocents. If a PC uses their action for a DC 16 Persuasion check, Senna has disadvantage on attacks until her next turn, or calls a ceasefire.

Tactical Bulwark. Allied soldiers within 20 ft of Senna gain a +2 bonus to AC and saving throws.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. Senna makes three Officer's Sabre attacks.

Master's Sabre. Melee Weapon Attack: +7 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. Hit: 8 (1d8 + 4) slashing plus 7 (2d6) radiant damage. Can choose non-lethal.

Order: Stand Down (1/Battle). Triggered by DC 16 Persuasion check. Senna orders: 'Hold your steel! We are not butchers!' All remaining Veterans take the Dodge action and cease attacking.

BONUS ACTIONS

Commander's Re-alignment (Recharge 5–6). Three allies within 30 ft disengage for free and move up to 20 ft.

REACTIONS

Riposte & Disarm. When a creature misses Senna with a melee attack, she makes a melee attack against that creature. On a hit, target drops its weapon (DC 15 Str save).

GM Tactics & Morale: Holds the secondary line 20 ft behind Harran, directing defensive maneuvers. If appealed to emotionally or shown civilian casualties, she can be persuaded (DC 16 Persuasion) to halt her soldiers.

FACTION 1: THE DELUDED LIGHT FANATICS — SOLAR OFFICERS & INQUISITORS

RECKONING LIGHT-INQUISITOR

SOLAR ZEALOT · PURIFYING INQUISITOR

Medium humanoid (human), lawful neutral

Armor Class: 17 (breastplate + shield)

Hit Points: **88** (13d8 + 30)

`HP Tracking: ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -8`

Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
16 (+3)	14 (+2)	16 (+3)	14 (+2)	16 (+3)	16 (+3)

Saving Throws: Wis +6, Cha +6, Con +6
Skills: Religion +5, Intimidation +6, Perception +6
Senses: Passive Perception 16
Languages: Common, Celestial
Challenge: 6 (2,300 XP)

Aura of Blinding Light. Bright light shines 20 ft around the Inquisitor. Hostile creatures entering or starting turn in the light must succeed on DC 14 Con save or be blinded until end of next turn.

Zealot's Retribution. When an ally within 30 ft drops to 0 HP, the Inquisitor gains advantage on all attacks until end of next turn.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. Makes two Radiant Flail attacks and one Solar Brand.

Radiant Flail. Melee Weapon Attack: +6 to hit, reach 5 ft. Hit: 7 (1d8 + 3) bludgeoning plus 9 (2d8) radiant damage.

Purifying Flare (Recharge 5–6). Releases a 20-ft burst of solar heat. Each hostile creature must make DC 15 Con save, taking 27 (6d8) radiant damage and being blinded for 1 min (save end of turn), or half damage on success.

GM Tactics & Morale: Targets party spellcasters and healers. Uses Purifying Flare early to blind frontliners, then hammers casters with Radiant Flail.

FANATIC SUN-PRIEST

SOLAR CHANNELER · MARTYR VOICE

Medium humanoid (human), lawful neutral

Armor Class: 15 (chain shirt + shield)

Hit Points: **68** (11d8 + 19)

`HP Tracking: ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -8`

Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
12 (+1)	12 (+1)	14 (+2)	12 (+1)	18 (+4)	14 (+2)

Saving Throws: Wis +7, Con +5
Skills: Religion +4, Insight +7, Perception +7
Senses: Passive Perception 17
Languages: Common, Celestial
Challenge: 5 (1,800 XP)

Solar Spellcasting. Wisdom is spellcasting ability (DC 15, +7 to hit). At-will: Sacred Flame (2d8), Light. 1st level (4 slots): Guiding Bolt (upcast 5d6 radiant), Healing Word. 2nd level (3 slots): Spiritual Weapon, Hold Person. 3rd level (2 slots): Daylight, Spirit Guardians (radiant 3d8).

ACTIONS

Solar Searing Bolt. Ranged Spell Attack: +7 to hit, range 120 ft. Hit: 18 (4d6 + 4) radiant damage, and next attack against target has advantage.

BONUS ACTIONS

Spiritual Weapon / Healing Word. Summons a glowing golden blade (1d8+4 radiant) or heals an ally for 1d4+4 HP.

GM Tactics & Morale: Casts Spirit Guardians on turn 1, stays behind the shield wall, uses Guiding Bolt to paint targets for Marksmen.

FACTION 1: THE DELUDED LIGHT FANATICS — RANK & FILE INFANTRY

RECKONING VETERAN

VARENHOLD GARRISON INFANTRY · SHIELD WALL

Medium humanoid (human), lawful neutral

Armor Class: 18 (plate)

Hit Points: 72 (10d8 + 27)

HP Tracking: ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -2

Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
16 (+3)	12 (+1)	16 (+3)	10 (+0)	12 (+1)	11 (+0)

Saving Throws: Str +5, Con +5
Skills: Athletics +5, Perception +3
Senses: Passive Perception 13
Languages: Common
Challenge: 4 (1,100 XP)

Interlocking Shield Wall. Gains +1 AC (max +3) for each adjacent conscious ally wielding a shield. Allied creatures behind the wall have half cover.

Disciplined Advance. Advantage on saving throws against being knocked prone, grappled, or moved against its will.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. Makes two Longsword attacks or one Longsword attack and one Shield Bash.

Longsword. Melee Weapon Attack: +5 to hit, reach 5 ft. Hit: 8 (1d8 + 4) slashing plus 4 (1d8) radiant damage.

Shield Bash. Melee Weapon Attack: +5 to hit, reach 5 ft. Hit: 6 (1d6 + 3) bludgeoning. Target must succeed on DC 14 Str save or be knocked prone.

REACTIONS

Interpose Shield. Imposes disadvantage on an attack roll against an adjacent ally.

GM Tactics & Morale: Forms a tight wedge with other Veterans, pushing PCs off the ritual stones and locking down casters.

RECKONING CROSSBOW MARKSMAN

ROOFTOP SNIPER · SUPPRESSIVE FIRE

Medium humanoid (human), lawful neutral

Armor Class: 15 (studded leather)

Hit Points: 52 (8d8 + 16)

HP Tracking: ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -2

Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
12 (+1)	16 (+3)	14 (+2)	11 (+0)	14 (+2)	10 (+0)

Saving Throws: Dex +5
Skills: Perception +4, Stealth +5
Senses: Passive Perception 14
Languages: Common
Challenge: 3 (700 XP)

Sniper's Elevation. Advantage on ranged attacks if at least 10 ft above the target. Ignores half cover.

Solar-Tipped Bolts. Crossbow attacks deal an extra 7 (2d6) fire/radiant damage (included below).

ACTIONS

Multiattack. Makes two Heavy Crossbow attacks.

Heavy Crossbow. Ranged Weapon Attack: +5 to hit, range 100/400 ft. Hit: 8 (1d10 + 3) piercing plus 7 (2d6) radiant damage.

Pinning Volley (Recharge 5–6). Aimed bolt at target's legs/gear: +5 to hit. Hit: 14 (2d10 + 3) piercing. Target's speed is reduced to 0 until end of next turn (DC 14 Dex save).

GM Tactics & Morale: Positioned on colonnades and archways. Focus fires on party spellcasters maintaining concentration.

DELUDED ZEALOT MILITIAMAN

FERVENT CITIZEN · DESPERATE CONSCRIPT

Medium humanoid (human), chaotic neutral

Armor Class: 13 (padded armor or leather)

Hit Points: 33 (6d8 + 6) HP Tracking: ☐ -5 ☐ -5 ☐ -5 ☐ -5 ☐ -5 ☐ -5 ☐ -5

Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
14 (+2)	12 (+1)	13 (+1)	9 (-1)	10 (+0)	12 (+1)

Skills: Intimidation +3
Senses: Passive Perception 10
Languages: Common
Challenge: 1 (200 XP)

Reckless Martyrdom. Advantage on melee attack rolls, but attack rolls against it have advantage.

Martyr's Flash. When reduced to 0 HP, releases a blinding solar burst. Creatures within 5 ft must succeed on DC 12 Con save or be blinded until end of next turn.

ACTIONS

Spear / Pitchfork. Melee Weapon Attack: +4 to hit, reach 5 ft. Hit: 6 (1d8 + 2) piercing plus 3 (1d6) radiant damage.

GM Tactics & Morale: Swarms in numbers. Uses reckless attacks to pin PCs in place so Veterans and Harran can advance.

THE RECKONING: BATTLEFIELD MORALE & DE-ESCALATION

The Core Tragic Lie: The Reckoning believes the Dawnborn are 'hoarding the sun's stolen essence.' They think slaying or forcing them into the stone circle will release the dawn and feed the starving city.

Shield Wall Tactics: Veterans and Militiamen advance in tight interlocking formations. Crossbow Marksmen provide suppressive cover fire to pin party casters.

The Moral De-escalation:

• *Lieutenant Senna Kard (DC 15 Persuasion):* If confronted with civilian casualties or shown Corven's peaceful defense, she orders her soldiers to stand down.

• *Commander Harran Lecht (Unforgiving):* Cannot be talked down while conscious. When reduced to 0 HP, seeing the golden dawn aura awaken the circle shatters his fanatical delusion in tears.

FACTION 2: THE UNDEAD (THE CONCORDANCE) — RULED BY ARCH-LICH VHOL

ARCH-LICH VHOL

RULER OF THE CONCORDANCE · MASTER OF THE INWARD CRESCENT

Medium undead, neutral evil

Armor Class: 18 (natural armor + unholy ward)

Hit Points: 195 (23d8 + 92)

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HP Tracking: □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -5
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Speed: 30 ft., fly 40 ft. (hover)

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
12 (+1)	16 (+3)	18 (+4)	22 (+6)	18 (+4)	18 (+4)

Saving Throws: Con +10, Int +12, Wis +10, Cha +10
Skills: Arcana +14, History +12, Insight +10, Perception +10
Damage Resistances: Cold, lightning
Damage Immunities: Necrotic, poison; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks
Condition Immunities: Charmed, exhaustion, frightened, paralyzed, poisoned
Senses: Truesight 60 ft., Darkvision 120 ft., Passive Perception 20
Languages: Common, Elvish, Undercommon, Abyssal
Challenge: 16 (15,000 XP)

Legendary Resistance (3/Day). If Vhol fails a saving throw, he can choose to succeed instead.

Rejuvenation (Phylactery). If destroyed, gains a new body in 1d10 days unless his phylactery hidden in the aqueduct crypts is destroyed.

Turn Immunity. Vhol is immune to effects that turn undead.

Inversion Nexus Aura. Living creatures within 30 ft cannot regain HP. Any spell or radiant ability within 30 ft is corrupted: radiant damage becomes necrotic.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. Vhol uses Paralyzing Void-Touch and casts one cantrip or 1st-level spell.

Paralyzing Void-Touch. Melee Spell Attack: +11 to hit, reach 5 ft. Hit: 18 (4d6 + 4) cold plus 18 (4d6 + 4) necrotic. Target must succeed on DC 19 Con save or be paralyzed for 1 minute (save end of turn).

Null-Beam of the Void (Recharge 5–6). 60-ft line, 10 ft wide. 55 (10d10) necrotic damage (DC 19 Dex half). Dispels all spell effects of 5th level or lower in the area.

Finger of Death (1/Day). Target within 60 ft takes 61 (7d8 + 30) necrotic damage (DC 19 Con half). A humanoid killed rises immediately as a Concordance Ghast.

Spellcasting. DC 19 spell save, +11 to hit. At-will: Toll the Dead (4d12), Shield (at will), Counterspell (3 slots, +6 check), Dispel Magic (3 slots), Blight (2 slots, 8d8 necrotic), Circle of Death (1 slot, 8d6 necrotic, 60-ft sphere).

BONUS ACTIONS

Void Step. Teleports up to 30 ft to an unoccupied dark space.

REACTIONS

Counterspell (3rd Slot, 3/Day). Interrupts a spell of 3rd level or lower cast within 60 ft.

GM Tactics & Morale: Hovers 15 ft above the battlefield out of melee reach. Counters radiant spells immediately. Uses Null-Beam down the main line of PCs, then casts Circle of Death or Finger of Death on the primary healer/paladin. Uses Disrupt Life when surrounded.

NULL-WARDEN

ELITE INVERSION JUGGERNAUT · SPELL-BREAKER

Medium humanoid (shadar-kai), lawful neutral

Armor Class: 19 (obsidian-etched plate)

Hit Points: 185 (20d8 + 95)

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HP Tracking: □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -5
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Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
21 (+5)	14 (+2)	20 (+5)	16 (+3)	18 (+4)	12 (+1)

Saving Throws: Str +10, Con +10, Wis +9, Int +8
Skills: Arcana +8, Athletics +10, Perception +9
Damage Resistances: Necrotic; bludgeoning, piercing, slashing from nonmagical attacks
Condition Immunities: Charmed, frightened
Senses: Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 19
Languages: Common, Elvish, Undercommon
Challenge: 13 (10,000 XP)

Greater Null Aura. Creatures within 15 ft cannot cast spells of 3rd level or lower. Spells of 4th level or higher require a DC 17 Con check or fail and the slot is expended.

Magic Resistance. Advantage on saving throws against spells and other magical effects.

Inversion Anchor. Immune to forced movement, cannot be knocked prone. Standing on ritual plinths grants +2 AC.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. Makes three Null Rod attacks.

Null Rod. Melee Weapon Attack: +10 to hit, reach 5 ft. Hit: 11 (1d10 + 5) bludgeoning plus 14 (3d8) necrotic. Target must succeed on DC 17 Con save or lose concentration immediately.

Sever Resonance (Recharge 5–6). 30-ft cone shockwave. 45 (10d8) force damage (DC 17 Con half). Dispels all active spell buffs of 4th level or lower on affected targets.

BONUS ACTIONS

Shadow Step (Recharge 4–6). Teleports up to 35 ft into dim light or shadow. Has advantage on next attack.

REACTIONS

Spell Reflection. When targeted by a spell that misses or allows a save that passes, reflects the spell back at the caster.

GM Tactics & Morale: Shadow steps directly into party backline to envelop casters in Greater Null Aura. Swings Null Rod to shatter concentration, then unleashes Sever Resonance.

FACTION 2: THE UNDEAD (THE CONCORDANCE) — INVERSION COMMANDERS

UNLIT DREAD SHADOW-KEEPER

DEATHLESS GENERAL · TACTICAL CELL COMMANDER

Medium humanoid (shadar-kai), lawful evil

Armor Class: 18 (dark iron plate)

Hit Points: **135** (18d8 + 54)

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HP Tracking: □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -5
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Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
18 (+4)	18 (+4)	18 (+4)	14 (+2)	16 (+3)	16 (+3)

Saving Throws: Str +8, Con +8, Wis +7
Skills: Stealth +8, Perception +7, Athletics +8
Damage Resistances: Necrotic
Senses: Darkvision 120 ft., Passive Perception 17
Languages: Common, Elvish, Undercommon
Challenge: 10 (5,900 XP)

Enveloping Umbra (15 ft Aura). Magical darkness moves with the Shadow-Keeper. Only darkvision from magical sources (or Truesight) pierces it.

Shadow General. All undead allies within 30 ft add 1d8 necrotic damage to melee weapon attacks.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. Makes three Shadow Glaive attacks.

Shadow Glaive. Melee Weapon Attack: +8 to hit, reach 10 ft. Hit: 10 (1d10 + 4) slashing plus 11 (2d10) necrotic damage.

Shadow Drain (Recharge 5–6). Target must succeed on DC 16 Con save or take 36 (8d8) necrotic damage and have its Strength score reduced by 1d4.

BONUS ACTIONS

Shadow Step. Teleports up to 40 ft between shadows.

REACTIONS

Cell Commander Strike. When an enemy misses an attack within 30 ft, grants an undead ally an immediate reaction attack with advantage.

GM Tactics & Morale: Opens with Enveloping Umbra to blind backline party members. Teleports with Shadow Step and coordinates Operatives and Returned.

HIGH PRIEST OF THE INWARD CRESCENT

ECLIPSE PRELATE · DEATH CHANNELER

Medium humanoid (human), lawful evil

Armor Class: 16 (scale mail + shield)

Hit Points: **120** (16d8 + 48)

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HP Tracking: □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10
```

Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
14 (+2)	12 (+1)	16 (+3)	16 (+3)	18 (+4)	14 (+2)

Saving Throws: Int +7, Wis +8, Con +7
Skills: Religion +7, Arcana +7, Perception +8
Damage Resistances: Necrotic
Senses: Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 18
Languages: Common, Undercommon
Challenge: 9 (5,000 XP)

Eclipse Spellcasting. Wisdom is spellcasting ability (DC 16, +8 to hit). At-will: Toll the Dead (3d12). 1st level (4 slots): Inflict Wounds (upcast 4d10 necrotic), Shield of Faith. 2nd level (3 slots): Hold Person, Darkness. 3rd level (3 slots): Spirit Guardians (necrotic 4d8), Counterspell. 4th level (2 slots): Blight (8d8 necrotic). 5th level (1 slot): Flame Strike (5d6 fire + 5d6 necrotic).

Twilight Bastion. When an undead ally within 30 ft takes damage, the Priest grants it 20 temporary hit points.

ACTIONS

Inflict Dread. Melee Spell Attack: +8 to hit, reach 5 ft. Hit: 22 (4d10) necrotic damage.

GM Tactics & Morale: Maintains 4th-level Spirit Guardians, counterspells radiant magic, grants 20 temp HP shields to Null-Wardens.

FACTION 2: THE UNDEAD (THE CONCORDANCE) — THEOLOGICAL OFFICERS & NECROMANCERS

UNLIT DOCTRINAL VOICE

GRAND INQUISITOR · MIND-BENDER

Medium humanoid (shadar-kai), lawful evil

Armor Class: 15 (unholy wards)

Hit Points: 105 (15d8 + 38)

```
HP Tracking: □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -5
```

Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	14 (+2)	16 (+3)	20 (+5)	18 (+4)	16 (+3)

Saving Throws: Int +9, Wis +8, Cha +7
Skills: Deception +7, Arcana +9, Insight +8
Damage Resistances: Psychic, necrotic
Senses: Passive Perception 14
Languages: Common, Elvish, Undercommon
Challenge: 9 (5,000 XP)

Legendary Resistance (2/Day). Can choose to succeed on a failed saving throw.

Psychic Dominance. DC 17 spell save. Spells: Hypnotic Pattern, Hold Monster (DC 17), Synaptic Static (8d6 psychic), Greater Invisibility, Counterspell.

ACTIONS

Mind-Shatter Lance. Ranged Spell Attack: +9 to hit, range 90 ft. Hit: 23 (4d8 + 5) psychic damage, and target cannot take reactions until end of next turn.

Overwhelming Decree (Recharge 5–6). All non-undead within 30 ft must succeed on DC 17 Int save or take 36 (8d8) psychic damage and be stunned until end of next turn.

GM Tactics & Morale: Casts Greater Invisibility on turn 1. Stays at maximum range launching Mind-Shatter Lance and Overwhelming Decree to stun frontliners.

DUSK HIGH PRIEST

CRYPT DOMINATOR · ANIMATE LORD

Medium humanoid (human), neutral evil

Armor Class: 16 (breastplate + shield)

Hit Points: 110 (15d8 + 45)

```
HP Tracking: □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10
```

Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
14 (+2)	12 (+1)	16 (+3)	14 (+2)	18 (+4)	16 (+3)

Saving Throws: Wis +8, Cha +7, Con +7
Skills: Religion +6, Perception +8
Damage Resistances: Necrotic
Senses: Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 18
Languages: Common, Undercommon
Challenge: 8 (3,900 XP)

Crypt Master. Undead allies within 20 ft gain advantage on saving throws against turn undead and radiant effects.

Combat Animation. When a humanoid falls within 30 ft, can use a reaction to animate it as a Concordance Skeleton under its control.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. Makes two Sacrificial Blade attacks or casts a spell and makes one attack.

Sacrificial Blade. Melee Weapon Attack: +6 to hit, reach 5 ft. Hit: 6 (1d4 + 4) piercing plus 14 (4d6) necrotic damage.

Necrotic Eruption (Recharge 5–6). A 20-ft radius eruption of unholy earth: 31 (7d8) necrotic damage (DC 16 Dex half).

GM Tactics & Morale: Commands The Returned to pin down targets. Uses Combat Animation to turn dead party allies/NPCs into skeletons immediately.

FACTION 2: THE UNDEAD (THE CONCORDANCE) — INFILTRATORS & DEATHLESS RANKS

UNLIT SHADOW-OPERATIVE

SHADAR-KAI ELITE ASSASSIN · CELL INFILTRATOR

Medium humanoid (shadar-kai), lawful neutral

Armor Class: 16 (studded leather)

Hit Points: **82** (12d8 + 28)

`HP Tracking: ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -2`

Speed: 35 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
12 (+1)	18 (+4)	14 (+2)	14 (+2)	14 (+2)	10 (+0)

Saving Throws: Dex +7, Wis +5
Skills: Stealth +10, Acrobatics +7, Perception +5
Damage Resistances: Necrotic
Senses: Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 15
Languages: Common, Elvish
Challenge: 6 (2,300 XP)

Assassinate & Pack Tactics. Advantage on attack rolls against any creature that hasn't taken a turn, or if an ally is within 5 ft. Critical hit against surprised creatures.

Sneak Attack (1/Turn). Deals an extra 14 (4d6) damage to a target it hits with a weapon attack with advantage.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. Makes three Shortsword attacks or two Hand Crossbow attacks.

Poisoned Shortsword. Melee Weapon Attack: +7 to hit, reach 5 ft. Hit: 7 (1d6 + 4) piercing plus 7 (2d6) poison damage.

Hand Crossbow. Ranged Weapon Attack: +7 to hit, range 30/120 ft. Hit: 7 (1d6 + 4) piercing plus 7 (2d6) necrotic.

BONUS ACTIONS

Shadow Step. Teleports up to 35 ft into dim light or darkness.

REACTIONS

Fade into Shadow. When hit by an attack, teleports 30 ft and takes half damage.

GM Tactics & Morale: Shadow-steps behind paralyzed or engaged PCs. Delivers 4d6 sneak attacks. Fades when targeted.

CONCORDANCE OBSIDIAN LEGIONNAIRE

ARMORED TOMB GUARD · INDESTRUCTIBLE PHALANX

Medium undead, lawful evil

Armor Class: 18 (obsidian plate + tower shield)

Hit Points: **52** (8d8 + 16)

`HP Tracking: ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -2`

Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
16 (+3)	12 (+1)	15 (+2)	8 (-1)	10 (+0)	5 (-3)

Saving Throws: Str +5, Con +4
Skills: None
Damage Immunities: Poison
Damage Vulnerabilities: Bludgeoning
Condition Immunities: Exhaustion, poisoned
Senses: Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 10
Languages: Understands Common
Challenge: 3 (700 XP)

Phalanx Wall. Adjacent legionnaires grant +2 AC to each other and half cover to allies behind them.

Obsidian Magic Shell. Advantage on saving throws against spells and magical effects.

ACTIONS

Necrotic Halberd. Melee Weapon Attack: +5 to hit, reach 10 ft. Hit: 8 (1d10 + 3) slashing plus 7 (2d6) necrotic damage.

Halberd Trip. Target must succeed on DC 13 Str save or be knocked prone.

GM Tactics & Morale: Locks down chokepoints and doorways with 10 ft reach halberds. Trips frontline tanks so Ghasts can swarm them.

THE RETURNED (DREAD GHAST)

BRANDED UNDEAD · APEX PARALYZER

Medium undead, chaotic evil

Armor Class: 15 (hardened necrotic hide)

Hit Points: **85** (12d8 + 31)

`HP Tracking: ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -5`

Speed: 35 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
18 (+4)	14 (+2)	16 (+3)	11 (+0)	12 (+1)	8 (-1)

Saving Throws: Con +6
Skills: Perception +4, Athletics +7
Damage Resistances: Necrotic
Damage Immunities: Poison
Condition Immunities: Charmed, exhaustion, poisoned, paralyzed
Senses: Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 14
Languages: Understands Common
Challenge: 5 (1,800 XP)

Putrid Stench. Any creature starting its turn within 10 ft must succeed on DC 15 Con save or be poisoned for 1 minute.

Pack Tactics & Turning Defiance. Advantage on attack rolls when an ally is within 5 ft. Advantage on saves against turn undead.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. Makes one Bite attack and two Claw attacks.

Paralyzing Claws. Melee Weapon Attack: +7 to hit, reach 5 ft. Hit: 9 (2d4 + 4) slashing plus 7 (2d6) necrotic. Non-undead must succeed on DC 15 Con save or be paralyzed for 1 minute.

Devouring Bite. Melee Weapon Attack: +7 to hit, reach 5 ft. Hit: 13 (2d8 + 4) piercing. If target is paralyzed, this attack is an automatic critical hit, and Ghast heals 10 HP.

GM Tactics & Morale: Swarms heavily armored tanks. Inflicts paralysis with claws, then bites to heal. Operatives focus on the paralyzed target.

THE CONCORDANCE: INVERSION CHAMBER HAZARDS & PHYLACTERY

Arch-Lich Vhol's Phylactery: Hidden within the sub-aqueduct crypts behind three lead-lined stone seals. Vhol cannot be permanently destroyed until the phylactery is crushed.

Null Inversion Field: Within 60 ft of the Concordance Plinth, magical light spells of 3rd level or lower are automatically dispelled at initiative count 20.

Synergy with The Returned: Operatives shadow-step behind paralyzed targets to deliver automatic critical sneak attacks. Skeletal Legionnaires form choke points to keep PCs inside necrotic Spirit Guardians.

FACTION 3: THE FLOWERING (THE MUTANTS) — FLESH MASTERS & TENDRIL HORRORS

THE GARDENER (MASTER FLESH-SHAPER)

LEADER OF THE FLOWERING · ARCHITECT OF IMPOSSIBLE FLESH

Medium aberration (formerly humanoid), neutral evil

Armor Class: 17 (Living Chitinous Weave)

Hit Points: **175** (19d8 + 95)

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HP Tracking: □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -5
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Speed: 35 ft., climb 35 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
18 (+4)	20 (+5)	20 (+5)	20 (+5)	16 (+3)	16 (+3)

Saving Throws: Con +9, Int +9, Wis +7, Dex +9
Skills: Medicine +9, Nature +9, Stealth +9, Perception +7
Damage Resistances: Acid, cold; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks
Condition Immunities: Charmed, frightened, paralyzed, poisoned
Senses: Blindsight 30 ft., Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 17
Languages: Common, Sylvan, Deep Speech
Challenge: 12 (8,400 XP)

Apex Aberrant Regeneration. Regains 20 hit points at start of turn unless he took fire or radiant damage since his last turn.

Graft Symbiosis. While within 10 ft of another mutant, half of any damage The Gardener takes is transferred to that mutant.

Legendary Resistance (3/Day). Can choose to succeed on a failed saving throw.

Graft Command. All mutant allies within 30 ft have advantage on attack rolls against grappled or restrained creatures.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. Makes four Grafted Bone-Scalpel strikes, or two Scalpel strikes and exhales Mutagenic Vapors.

Grafted Bone-Scalpel. Melee Weapon Attack: +9 to hit, reach 10 ft. Hit: 12 (2d6 + 5) slashing plus 9 (2d8) acid. Target must make DC 17 Con save or be poisoned for 1 min.

Mutagenic Vapors (Recharge 5–6). 30-ft cone of sweet mutagenic pollen. 45 (10d8) acid/poison damage (DC 17 Con half). On fail, target's muscles warp: disadvantage on attacks and speed halved for 1 min.

BONUS ACTIONS

Tendril Lash. Makes one Bone-Scalpel attack.

REACTIONS

Rubbery Deflection. Adds +4 to AC against one attack by rippling rubbery skin layers.

GM Tactics & Morale: Stays behind Tendril Behemoth and Abomination, transferring 50% damage to them while regenerating 20 HP/turn. Uses Flesh Puppetry to turn party members or summon graft horrors. His primary obsession is capturing Ixa alive.

GRASPING TENDRIL BEHEMOTH

COLOSSAL BIO-HORROR · THE COLLECTOR

Huge aberration, unaligned

Armor Class: 15 (thick rubbery hide)

Hit Points: **145** (16d10 + 57)

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HP Tracking: □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -5
```

Speed: 40 ft., climb 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
22 (+6)	16 (+3)	20 (+5)	8 (-1)	12 (+1)	4 (-3)

Saving Throws: Str +10, Con +9
Skills: Athletics +10, Stealth +7
Damage Resistances: Bludgeoning, piercing, acid
Condition Immunities: Charmed, frightened, prone
Senses: Blindsight 40 ft., Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 11
Languages: Understands Common
Challenge: 9 (5,000 XP)

Target Lock (Ixa / Priority Capture). The Behemoth moves at full speed while carrying up to two grappled creatures.

Multi-Appendage Grasp. Has 4 colossal tendrils. Can grapple up to four targets at once (escape DC 18).

Flexible Form. Can squeeze through spaces as tight as 3 ft wide without penalty.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. Makes three Grasping Slam attacks.

Grasping Slam. Melee Weapon Attack: +10 to hit, reach 15 ft. Hit: 17 (2d10 + 6) bludgeoning. Target is grappled (escape DC 18) and pulled 10 ft toward the Behemoth.

Crushing Constriction. Each grappled creature takes 22 (3d10 + 6) bludgeoning plus 9 (2d8) acid damage.

BONUS ACTIONS

Vent Chute Haul. Drags all grappled targets up to 25 ft toward the sunken vent chutes.

REACTIONS

Whiplash Lash. When attacked from outside 10 ft, lashes out: +10 to hit, 12 (1d12+6) bludgeoning, pulls attacker 10 ft.

GM Tactics & Morale: Ignores heavy armor tanks unless blocked. Reaches over defenders with 15 ft reach to snatch Ixa or backline casters, constricts them, and drags them toward the chutes.

FACTION 3: THE FLOWERING (THE MUTANTS) — ABERRANT FLESH CREATIONS

FLOWER-BRED FLESH GOLIATH

FOUR-ARMED MUTANT JUGGERNAUT · SIEGE ORGANISM

Large aberration, chaotic evil

Armor Class: 16 (thick scarred bone-plates)

Hit Points: 130 (14d10 + 53)

`HP Tracking: ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10`

Speed: 35 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
21 (+5)	12 (+1)	18 (+4)	6 (-2)	10 (+0)	5 (-3)

Saving Throws: Str +8, Con +7
Skills: Athletics +8
Damage Resistances: Bludgeoning
Damage Immunities: Poison
Condition Immunities: Frightened, poisoned
Senses: Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 10
Languages: Understands Common but only moans
Challenge: 8 (3,900 XP)

Relentless Flesh. When reduced to 0 HP, makes DC 10 Con save. On success, drops to 1 HP instead (unless damage was radiant or fire).

Four-Armed Crusher. Can grapple up to two Medium creatures while still making two slam attacks.

Siege Monster. Deals double damage to objects and structures.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. Makes three Slam attacks or one Caustic Bile Vomit and two Slams.

Mutant Slam. Melee Weapon Attack: +8 to hit, reach 5 ft. Hit: 14 (2d8 + 5) bludgeoning damage.

Caustic Bile Vomit (Recharge 5–6). 20-ft cone. 36 (8d8) acid damage (DC 15 Dex half).

BONUS ACTIONS

Brutal Shove. Shoves a grappled creature into a wall or floor: 10 (1d10 + 5) bludgeoning and knocks prone.

GM Tactics & Morale: Frontline battering ram. Smashes barricades, grapples party warriors, and holds them down for Spore-Spitters.

FAILED FLESH GRAFT-AMALGAM

CRAWLING FLESH REMNANT · MULTI-LIMBED HORROR

Small aberration, chaotic neutral

Armor Class: 13 (raw swollen tissue)

Hit Points: 55 (10d8 + 10)

`HP Tracking: ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -5`

Speed: 25 ft., climb 25 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
16 (+3)	12 (+1)	13 (+1)	4 (-3)	8 (-1)	3 (-4)

Skills: Athletics +5
Damage Resistances: Bludgeoning
Condition Immunities: Charmed, frightened
Senses: Blindsight 30 ft., Passive Perception 9
Languages: None
Challenge: 3 (700 XP)

Grasping Swarm Nuisance. Can enter hostile creature's space. A creature whose space it shares has speed halved and is grappled (escape DC 13).

The Not Dead. When reduced to 0 HP, twitches helplessly. DC 14 Medicine check confirms it is an altered citizen still alive inside.

ACTIONS

Lashing Tendril. Melee Weapon Attack: +5 to hit, reach 5 ft. Hit: 8 (1d10 + 3) bludgeoning.

Agonizing Pain Shriek (1/Day). Releases psychic screech in 15-ft radius. DC 14 Wis save or take 14 (4d6) psychic damage and be stunned until end of next turn.

GM Tactics & Morale: Crawls out of grates and gutters, wraps around boots, and lets out a deafening pain shriek to stun party members.

APEX BLOOM-STALKER

CAMOUFLAGED AMBUSH PREDATOR · TOXIC NEUROTOXIN

Medium aberration, neutral evil

Armor Class: 16 (petaled armored scales)

Hit Points: 88 (13d8 + 30)

`HP Tracking: ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -8`

Speed: 40 ft., climb 35 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
14 (+2)	20 (+5)	16 (+3)	8 (-1)	14 (+2)	6 (-2)

Saving Throws: Dex +8, Con +6
Skills: Stealth +11, Acrobatics +8, Perception +5
Damage Resistances: Poison, acid
Senses: Darkvision 60 ft., Tremorsense 30 ft., Passive Perception 15
Languages: Understands Common
Challenge: 6 (2,300 XP)

Chameleon Camouflage. Can take the Hide action as a bonus action in dim light, rubble, or adjacent to walls. Advantage on stealth.

Pounce. If moves 20 ft straight toward target and hits with claw, target must succeed DC 15 Str save or be knocked prone. Stalker can make bite as bonus action.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. Makes one Bite attack and two Claw attacks.

Neurotoxin Bite. Melee Weapon Attack: +8 to hit, reach 5 ft. Hit: 10 (1d10 + 5) piercing plus 14 (4d6) poison. Target must succeed DC 15 Con save or be paralyzed for 1 min.

Claw. Melee Weapon Attack: +8 to hit, reach 5 ft. Hit: 9 (1d8 + 5) slashing.

BONUS ACTIONS

Shadow Skulk. Takes Hide action as a bonus action in dim light.

GM Tactics & Morale: Stalks along rafters and ceilings. Pounces directly onto backline spellcasters, inflicts paralysis with Neurotoxin Bite, and drags them into the dark.

NOXIOUS SPORE-ARTILLERY

SWOLLEN RANGED ARTILLERY · BIO-MORTAR

Medium aberration, unaligned

Armor Class: 14 (chitinous pustules)

Hit Points: 75 (11d8 + 26)

`HP Tracking: ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -5`

Speed: 25 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
12 (+1)	16 (+3)	16 (+3)	5 (-3)	12 (+1)	4 (-3)

Saving Throws: Con +6
Skills: Perception +4
Damage Resistances: Acid, poison
Condition Immunities: Poisoned
Senses: Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 14
Languages: None
Challenge: 5 (1,800 XP)

Caustic Death Burst. When reduced to 0 HP, bursts in 20-ft radius: 28 (8d6) acid and poison damage (DC 15 Dex half).

ACTIONS

Multiattack. Fires two Caustic Spore Mortars.

Caustic Spore Mortar. Ranged Weapon Attack: +6 to hit, range 40/120 ft. Hit: 12 (2d8 + 3) acid plus 9 (2d8) poison damage, and creates a 5-ft pool of acid (5 acid damage if entered).

Hallucinogenic Spore Bomb (Recharge 5–6). Fires a spore bomb up to 60 ft, detonating in 15-ft radius. Each creature must make DC 15 Wis save or roll on confusion table for 1 minute.

GM Tactics & Morale: Stands on vantage points lobbing acid mortars. When party warriors close in, detonate self to wipe them out.

THE FLOWERING: FLESH HORROR DYNAMICS & RETRIEVAL OBJECTIVE

Target Lock on Ixa: The Flowering does not want to murder the party; they want to retrieve Ixa, whom they view as their sacred 'first perfect bloom.' Tendrils and Abominations focus on grappling and hauling her away.

Secondary Objective (Combat Win Condition): Prevent Ixa from being hauled past the 60-ft perimeter line into the sunken vents.

The Not Dead Horror: When reduced to 0 HP, mutants collapse into paralyzed heaps. A DC 14 Medicine check reveals they are former Varenhold citizens painfully rewritten by mutagenic alchemy, still conscious inside.